FY-901

Reg. No. : .....

Name : .....

FIRST YEAR HIGHER SECONDARY IMPROVEMENT/SUPPLEMENTARY EXAMINATION, OCTOBER 2026

Part – I

ENGLISH

Time : 2½ Hours

Cool-off time : 15 Minutes

Maximum : 80 Scores

General Instructions to Candidates :

- There is a 'Cool-off time' of 15 minutes in addition to the writing time.
- Use the 'Cool-off time' to get familiar with questions and to plan your answers.
- Read questions carefully before answering.
- Write answers to the specific number of questions as instructed.

Questions 1 – 8 : Answer all the questions. **(8 × 1 = 8)**

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow :

His first year at Cambridge was worse than that at Oxford. His slipshod mathematical background caught up with him, and he found general relativity extremely tough. Another far more disastrous problem arose then. ... He'd fallen once or twice for no apparent reason. The following autumn, at Cambridge, he had trouble tying his shoes and sometimes, he had difficulty talking.

1. The 'he' referred to is _____. (1)

2. What made general relativity extremely tough for 'him' ? (1)

3. 'Another far more disastrous problem arose then.' What is the 'problem' referred to ? (1)

4. Pick out the word from the passage that means 'clear'. (1)

Read the following lines and answer the questions that follow :

The glories of our blood and state
Are shadows, not substantial things;
There is no armour against Fate;
Death lays his icy hand on kings:
Sceptre and Crown
Must tumble down,
And in the dust be equal made
With the poor crooked scythe and spade.

5. What, according to the poet, are 'shadows' ? (1)

6. 'Death lays his icy hand on kings...' The poetic device used in this line is _____. (1)

7. Pick out an example of metonymy from the lines. (1)

8. The word that means 'a protective shield' is _____. (1)

Questions 9 – 12 : Answer any three of the following. Each question carries 2 scores. (3 × 2 = 6)

9. You are a tour guide at Kadavu, addressing a group of tourists who have assembled to watch the turtle calling. Write two **instructions** that you wish to give them.

10. **Report** the following conversation between Maggie and Mrs. Clifford, her mother :

Mrs. Clifford : Will Mr. Gupta visit me ?

Maggie : I've informed him that you wish to see him.

11. Dr. Kalam asks the youth to fight the hardest battle, that is, finding 'a UNIQUE YOU'. Based on your reading of Kalam's speech titled 'I will Fly', write two pieces of **advice** for the youth, to find their uniqueness.

12. **Complete the following sentences suitably :**

(a) If we start climbing the hill by 4:30 in the morning _____ (watch the sunrise from the hilltop by 6:00 am).

(b) _____ (start early in the evening) we would have arrived at the Belgian Frontiers by midnight.

Questions 13 – 19 : Answer any five of the following. Each question carries 4 scores. **(5 × 4 = 20)**

13. **Edit** the following sentences :
I always tells my friends that we should sleeping at last for seven hours. Sound sleep make us healthy and happy.

14. **Fill up the blanks choosing the correct cohesive device from the brackets.**
(thus, though, while, in order to)
The young seagull was not able to fly. (a) his parents had encouraged him to fly, he failed in his attempt. Then his mother decided to help him. (b) make him fly, she picked up a piece of fish and took it to him. He fell off his ledge (c) attempting to get near his mother. Then his wings spread and (d) he made his first flight.

15. Justify the title 'The Price of Flowers'.

16. You are doing rescue work in a locality hit by landslide. Write four **instructions** that you wish to give the rest of your team members on the first day of the operation.

17. **Elaborate on the idea** behind the following lines :
If you can dream – and not make dreams your master;
If you can think – and not make thoughts your aim,
If you can meet with Triumph and Disaster
And treat those two impostors just the same:
If you can bear to hear the truth you've spoken
Twisted by knaves to make a trap for fools,
Or watch the things you gave your life to, broken,
And stoop and build 'em up with worn-out tools;

18. You are one of the spectators who gathered at the gas works of La Villette to watch the take off of Le Horla. You are narrating the incident to one of your friends. Prepare your **narration**.

19. A debate is conducted in your class on the topic 'We cannot live without technology'. Write **four arguments** against it.

Questions 20 – 25 : Answer any five of the following. Each question carries 6 scores. **(5 × 6 = 30)**

20. Parental guidance is an important factor in the moulding of an individual. Analyse this statement in the light of your reading of 'His First Flight' and write your view in a **paragraph**.

21. The story 'The Serang of Ranaganji' reflects the virtue of kindness and compassion. Prepare a **review** of the story.

22. You get an opportunity to interview Jane Wilde, wife of Stephen Hawking. Write **three questions** that you wish to ask her and the possible **responses**.

23. You are the reporter of a news channel. During a voyage through the Atlantic, you cross the area where the wrecking of The Titanic occurred. You go online when your cruise ship reaches the spot. Draft the **commentary** for your video.

24. Maggie in 'The Price of Flowers' is a symbol of courage and commitment How far is this true ? Analyse her character and prepare a **character sketch** of Maggie.

25. After his visit to Nikolai's estate Ivan decides to buy a farmhouse somewhere near his brother's property. He writes a letter to Nikolai, expressing his wish. Draft the likely **letter**.

Questions 26 – 28 : Answer any two of the following. Each question carries 8 scores. **(2 × 8 = 16)**

26. You get an opportunity to address a group of NSS volunteers on Gandhi Jayanthi. Draft the **speech** referring to the need to sensitise our youth on the need to develop Gandhian values to maintain honesty and righteousness in our life.

27. You are a travel and food vlogger. Prepare a **travel essay** on your favourite destination, highlighting the major tourist attractions, the local cuisine (food) and all other features of the place that make it special.

28. Read the given poem and write an **appreciation**, highlighting the theme, imagery, poetic devices and style.

On Health

Jan Kochanowski

My good and noble health,
Thou matter'st more then wealth.
None know'th thy worth until
Thou fad'st, and we fall ill.

And every man can see,
In stark reality,
And every man will say:
" 'Tis health I need today".

No better thing we know,
No dearer gem we owe,
For all that we possess:
Pearls, stones of great finesse,
High offices and power